# FLEET TEAM DIGEST

## 737MAX-FTD-32-17030

**Issue Title :** Causes and Suggested Solutions for Nose Gear Vibration Reports

| Airplane Model | ATA | Minor Model(s) |
|---|---|---|
| 737MAX | 3220-00 | -7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ |

| Other Model(s) | ECCN |
|---|---|
| 737NG, 737 | 9E991 |

| Originated Date | Last Revised Date | Created On |
|---|---|---|
| 12/04/2017 | 12/04/2017 | 04/19/2017 |

| Estimated Completion Date | Next Update Date |
|---|---|
| | |

## Applicability

All 737MAX airplanes.

## Description

737 aircraft operators occasionally receive flight crew reports regarding unusual vibration levels from the nose gear that are felt during takeoff or landing rollout.

## Background

Suspected causes of nose gear vibration are:

* Worn or loose nose landing gear components such as steering collars, steering sleeves and plates, steering actuator trunnions or rod ends, and torsion links.

* Imbalanced wheels, tires or wheel/tire assemblies due to uneven tread wear or flat spots on tire tread, out of round tires, or out-of-balance wheels.

* Under-serviced or over-serviced NLG shock struts caused by loss of oil or gas or improper servicing methods.

Specific causes of uneven tread wear are unknown but we suspect the following items are contributing factors:

1) Operational conditions such as runways, climate, stopping techniques, taxi speeds and maneuvers (such as excessively sharp turns), and aircraft taxi weights

2) Tire and wheel balance

3) Radial vs. bias tire construction

See "Operator Action" section for suggestions to minimize the effect of the above suspected causes.

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## Status

Complete. See Operator Action below, and refer to 737NG-FTD-32-07002 for additional information regarding this issue.

## Interim Action

None.

## Final Action

Service letter 737-SL-32-145, titled "Nose Landing Gear Vibration", provides background, possible causes, and recommendations to address NLG vibration. See the Operator Action section below for suggestions to minimize the frequency of NLG vibration reports.

## Operator Action

The following are actions that Boeing suggests operators consider when trying to resolve nose vibration issues on their airplanes:

1) Ensure there is not excessive wear in nose gear joints. Perform torsional freeplay check per AMM as required.

2) Replace tires before they reach bottom of tread groove. Consider changing the wear limit to 1/16 inch (or more) remain tread depth.

3) Replace tires that have large flat spots as soon as possible.

4) Check with the retreader to ensure that new and retreaded tires are within acceptable balance limits.

5) Ensure wheels are within CMM balance limits.

6) Consider balancing the wheel/tire as assy. Reference 737-SL-32-145.

7) Avoid sharp turns during taxi and tow.

8) Avoid high speed taxi turns whenever possible.

9) Ensure that tire contact with the snubbers is not excessive. Check condition of snubber pads regularly per AMM 32-45-31/201.

10) Review service letter 737-SL-32-145 for additional suggestions that may help identify causes and reduce vibration reports.

11) Ensure that NLG shock strut is properly serviced with oil and gas per AMM 12-15-41/301. Using the 2 point method is the best way to ensure that strut has the proper oil level.

## Reference Categories

| Reference Type | Reference Number | Revision Number | Reference Date |
|---|---|---|---|
| Service Letter (SL) | 737-SL-32-101 | J | 01/09/2017 |

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|---|---|---|---|
| Fleet Team Economic (FTE) | 03268-737NG | | |
| Service Related Problem (SRP) | 737ng-SRP-32-0156 | | |
| Service Letter (SL) | 737-SL-32-071 | A | 02/26/2003 |
| Fleet Team Digest Article (FTD) | 737NG-FTD-32-07002 | | |
| Service Letter (SL) | 737-SL-32-055 | | 07/30/1993 |
| Service Letter (SL) | 737-SL-32-145 | C | 07/25/2012 |

## Related Categories

- Airplane Maintenance Issues : Issues that occur during airplane maintenance or have an impact on airplane reliability
- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability
- Fleet Team IdeaXchange : Topic of discussion on the Fleet Team IdeaXchange bulletin board
- In Service Occurrences : null

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